



A Bridge Between Us



When Sam moved to a new town, everything felt strange. The streets were unfamiliar, the faces were new, and even the cafeteria smelled different. Most of all, Sam missed the creaky floorboards of home and the sound of his old dog, Biscuit, padding down the hall.

On the first day of school, Sam sat alone at lunch, tracing patterns on the table with a plastic fork. Just then, a girl with paint-stained sleeves slid into the seat across from him.

“Mind if I sit here?” she asked, smiling.

Sam shrugged. “Sure.”

Her name was Leila. She loved sketching buildings, collecting interesting rocks, and asking questions that made people think. Before long, they were talking about everything—favorite books, the weirdest foods they’d tried, and how moving to a new place felt like learning a secret code.

The next weekend, Leila invited Sam to help with a community project. People in town were building a footbridge over Maple Creek, a place that often flooded after heavy rain. “It’ll help everyone get across safely,” Leila explained.

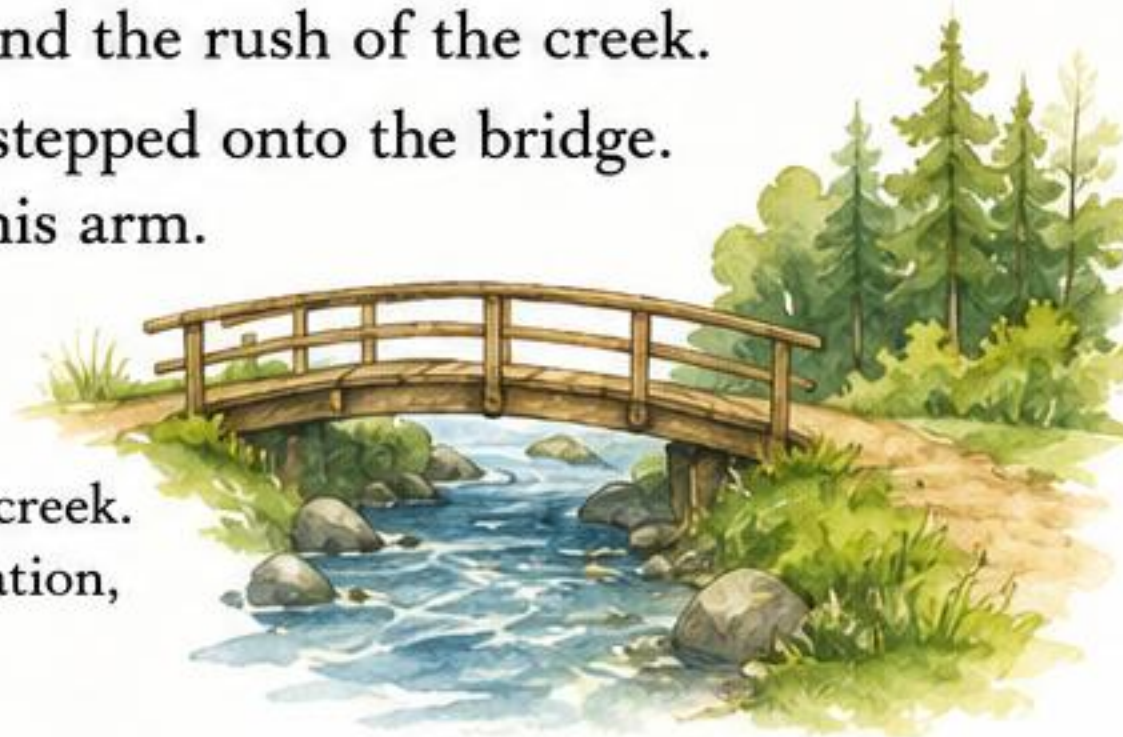
Sam had never built anything like that before, but soon he was measuring boards, holding tools, and learning knots that wouldn’t slip. Neighbors shared lemonade and stories. Laughter mixed with the sound of hammers and the rush of the creek.

When the last board was placed, everyone cheered. Sam stepped onto the bridge. It was sturdy, slightly bouncy, and beautiful. Leila nudged his arm.

“Look what a bunch of people can do,” she said.

Sam nodded. “Yeah. And look who can build it.”

From that day on, the bridge became more than a way to cross the creek. It was a reminder that new places can turn into home—one conversation, one act of kindness, one plank at a time.



KEY

Use the colours below to highlight or underline each part of the text.



Setting

Where and when the story takes place. (Look for time, place, and atmosphere.)



Characters

Who is in the story? (Underline the names and pronouns.)



Problem / Challenge

What is the main challenge or problem the characters face?



Events

What happens in the story? (Highlight key events in order.)



Climax

The most exciting or important part.



Resolution

How the problem is solved and how the story ends.



Theme / Lesson

The message or lesson the story teaches.



Figurative Language

Find similes, metaphors, or descriptive language. (Words that create strong pictures.)

The Amazing World of Bees

Bees may be small, but they play a huge role in keeping our world healthy. These hard-working insects help flowers grow, crops thrive, and ecosystems stay in balance. Let's take a closer look at the amazing world of bees.

What Are Bees?

Bees are insects that belong to a large group called pollinators. The most common bee species is the honey bee. Honey bees live in large groups called colonies or hives. A hive can have thousands of bees working together!

Life in a Hive

Every honey bee has a job to do. There are three main types of bees in a hive. The **queen** is the leader and her main job is to lay eggs. **Worker bees** are all female and they do many jobs, such as collecting food, cleaning the hive, and caring for baby bees. **Drones** are male bees, and their main job is to mate with the queen.

How Bees Help Our World

When bees visit flowers to gather nectar, tiny grains of pollen stick to their bodies. As they move from flower to flower, some of the pollen rubs off and helps plants make seeds and fruit. This process is called **pollination**. About one out of every three bites of food we eat exists because of pollinators like bees. That includes fruits, vegetables, nuts, and more!

Threats to Bees

Bees face many challenges today. Loss of flowers and natural habitats, harmful pesticides, diseases, and climate change make it harder for bees to survive. When bees disappear, it can cause big problems for plants, animals, and people.

How We Can Help

We can all help protect bees. Planting native flowers, avoiding pesticides, and leaving some wild spaces in our yards can make a big difference. Even something as simple as putting out a shallow dish of water with small rocks can give thirsty bees a safe place to drink.



Bees are tiny, but their impact is enormous.
By working together, we can help keep their future buzzing!



Did You Know?

- A single bee can visit up to 5,000 flowers in one day!
- Bees communicate by doing a "waggle dance."
- Honey never spoils! Archaeologists have found pots of honey in ancient tombs that were still good to eat.

KEY

Use the colours below to highlight or underline each part of the text.



Main Topic

What the text is mainly about.
(Title and overall idea)



Subheadings

The smaller topics that organize the information.



Key Ideas

Important details that support each subheading.



Facts / Examples

Specific facts, numbers, or examples that teach us something new.



Cause & Effect

Why things happen and what happens as a result.



Solutions / Actions

Ways people can help or what can be done about the problem.



Important Vocabulary

New or important words we should know.



Interesting Extras

Fun or surprising information.

Mountains: Nature's Mighty Wonders

Mountains have inspired people for thousands of years. They shape the land, affect the weather, and provide homes for plants, animals, and communities. Let's explore how mountains are formed, why they are important, and how people and nature thrive in these amazing places.

How Are Mountains Formed?

Mountains form in different ways, but the most common way is when huge pieces of Earth's crust called **tectonic plates** push against each other. When the plates collide, the land can crumple and fold upward, creating mountains. Volcanoes can also build mountains when magma from inside the Earth erupts and cools. Over millions of years, wind, rain, and ice shape mountains, too.

Types of Mountains

There are several types of mountains. Fold mountains, like the Himalayas, are formed by plate collisions. Volcanoes, like Mount Fuji, are built by eruptions. Dome mountains form when magma pushes up from below but doesn't erupt. Block mountains happen when sections of the Earth are lifted or dropped along cracks called faults.

Why Mountains Matter

Mountains are important for many reasons. They affect weather by forcing moist air upward, which can cause rain or snow. Mountains also store water. Snow that falls on peaks can melt slowly and feed rivers and lakes that provide fresh water to millions of people and animals. They are home to unique plants and animals found nowhere else on Earth.

People and Mountains

Many people live in or near mountains. They farm steep hillsides, mine minerals, and build towns in valleys. Mountains also give us natural resources like forests, energy from rivers, and beautiful places to explore. People hike, climb, ski, and camp in mountains to enjoy their beauty and challenge.

Protecting Our Mountains

Mountains can be fragile. Deforestation, pollution, and climate change can harm them. We can help by protecting forests, using resources wisely, and leaving no trace when we visit. When we care for mountains, they can continue to support life for generations to come.



Did You Know?

- The tallest mountain in the world, Mount Everest, is 8,849 metres tall!
- Mountains cover about 27% of Earth's land.
- Some mountains are older than 1 billion years!
- Plants grow in "zones" on mountains. As you climb higher, it gets colder, so different plants can grow.

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Cause & Effect

Why things happen and what happens as a result.



Importance

Why the topic matters or its impact on people, animals, or the planet.



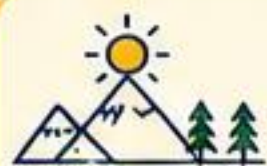
Solutions / Actions

Ways we can help or what can be done to make a difference.



Interesting Extras

Fun or surprising information.



Mountains are more than just big rocks—they are life-giving, inspiring, and powerful reminders of the natural world. Let's explore them responsibly and protect them for the future!

Our Planet, Our Promise

This poem is a reminder of the beauty of our planet and the choices we can make to care for it.

- 1 Blue oceans sparkle, mountains stand tall,
2 Forests whisper, rain falls,
3 From deserts dry to rivers wide,
4 Our planet is a place we all call home with pride.
- 5 The air we breathe, the water we drink,
6 The animals, the flowers—each life, each link,
7 Work together in a delicate chain,
8 Keeping our world alive, through sunshine and rain.
- 9 But our planet needs help, it's true,
10 Pollution, waste, and damage we do,
11 If we carelessly take more than our share,
12 Future generations won't have the same to share.
- 13 So let's make choices that are kind,
14 Reduce, reuse, recycle—keep that in mind,
15 Plant a tree, save energy, turn off the light,
16 Small actions today can make tomorrow bright.
- 17 We may be just one person, small in the crowd,
18 But together, our voices can be strong and proud.
19 Let's keep our promise, every girl and boy,
20 To protect our planet—our shared home and joy.



Think About It!

- ★ What is the poet encouraging us to do?
- ★ Which lines show how people and nature are connected?
- ★ What change can you make to help our planet?

KEY

Use the colours below to highlight or underline each part of the text.



Theme

The main message or big idea of the poem.



Imagery

Words and phrases that appeal to the senses and create vivid pictures.



Figurative Language

Similes, metaphors, or other figures of speech. (e.g., whisper, delicate chain)



Rhyme Scheme

Words that rhyme at the end of the lines.



Line Numbers

The numbers that show each line of the poem.



Call to Action

The lines that encourage the reader to take action or make a change.



Tone

The poet's attitude or feelings in the poem. (e.g., hopeful, caring, inspiring)



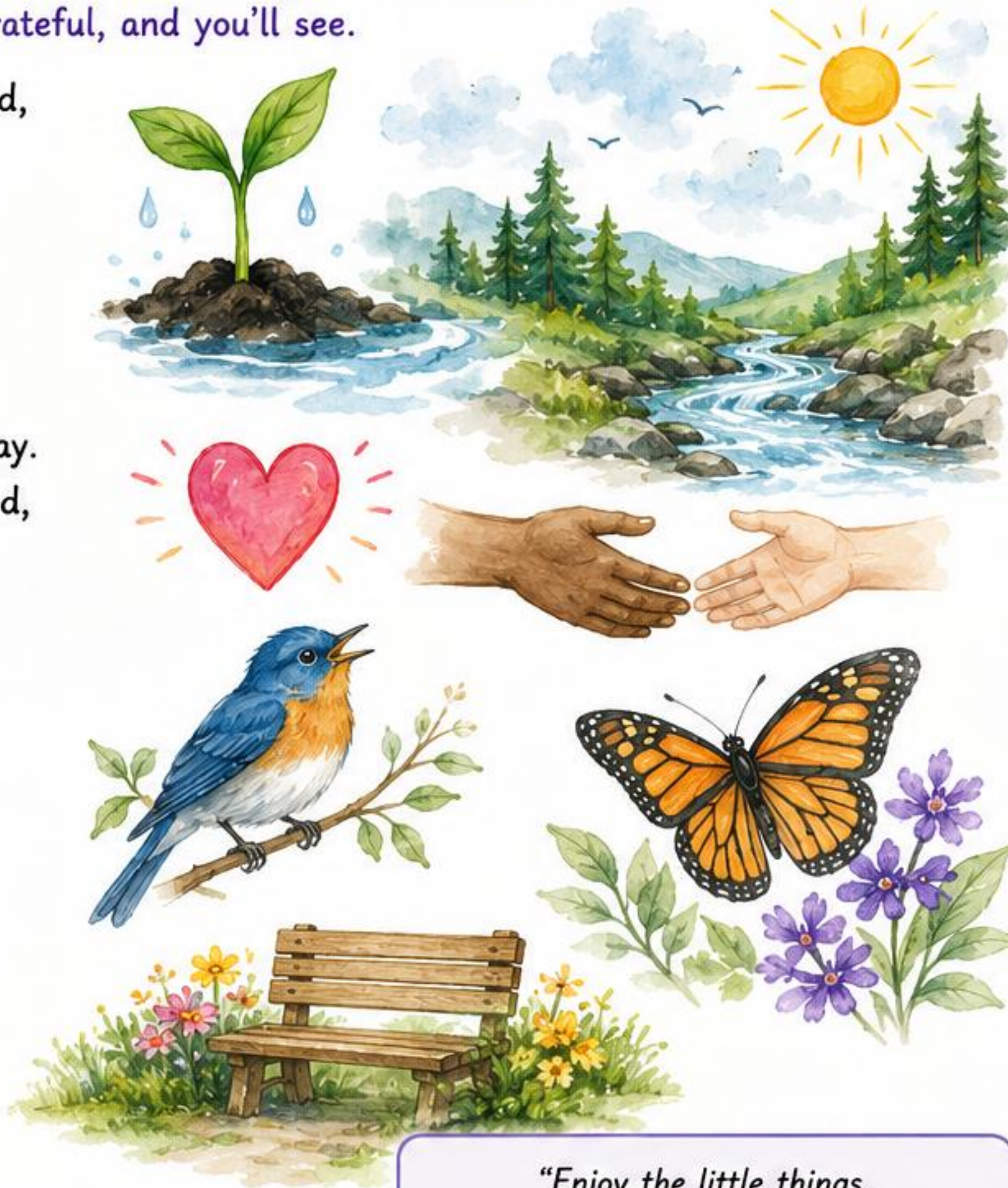
Questions for Thinking

Questions that help you understand the poem more deeply.

The Little Things

Sometimes the smallest things can make the biggest difference.
Look closely, be grateful, and you'll see.

- 1 A seed so small, beneath the ground,
2 Holds trees that touch the sky.
3 A single drop of rain can fall
4 And rivers soon go flowing by.
- 5 A kind word said to one in need
6 Can lift them up and change their day.
7 A smile that's shared, a helping hand,
8 Can chase the worries all away.
- 9 A bird that sings at early dawn,
10 A butterfly that flutters past,
11 They remind us to slow down awhile
12 And live each moment as it lasts.
- 13 The little things are all around,
14 In every place, for you and me.
15 When we take time to notice them,
16 Life's beauty is easy to see.
- 17 So let's be kind and grateful,
18 And do the best that we can do,
19 Because the little things we do today
20 Can make the world a better place for you.



*"Enjoy the little things,
for one day you may look back
and realize they were the
big things."
— Robert Brault*

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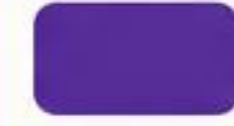
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Tone / Mood

The poet's attitude or
feelings in the poem.
(e.g., grateful, hopeful,
peaceful)



Structure

The way the poem is
organized (stanzas,
repetition, pattern, etc.).



Think Deeper

Questions or ideas that
help you understand
the poem more deeply.

The Lost Backpack

Maya swung her legs off the bus and took a deep breath. It was the day of the science fair, and she was excited—and a little nervous. Her volcano model was finished, her poster was perfect, and her speech was practised. She was ready.

Then she felt her stomach drop. Her backpack *wasn't* on her back.

She patted the seat. Nothing. She checked the steps of the bus. Nothing. Panic bubbled up. Inside that backpack was her science journal, her notes, and the flash drive with her presentation.

"This can't be happening," she whispered.

Maya ran inside and told her teacher. "Let's retrace your steps," Mrs. Patel said. "Where did you last see it?"

Maya thought hard. "I showed my friend Leo my model at the front of the bus. Then I sat near the middle."

Mrs. Patel smiled kindly. "Then that's where we'll start."

They checked the bus with the driver's help. No backpack. The office checked lost and found. Nothing. Maya's eyes stung with tears.

Just then, Leo came running. "Maya! Wait! I think I know something."

He had remembered that another student got off at the next stop after Maya. They asked the driver to radio ahead. A few minutes later, the answer came: "Yes! A backpack was turned in at the community centre."

Maya and Mrs. Patel hurried over. There it was—sitting on the front desk, exactly where it belonged.

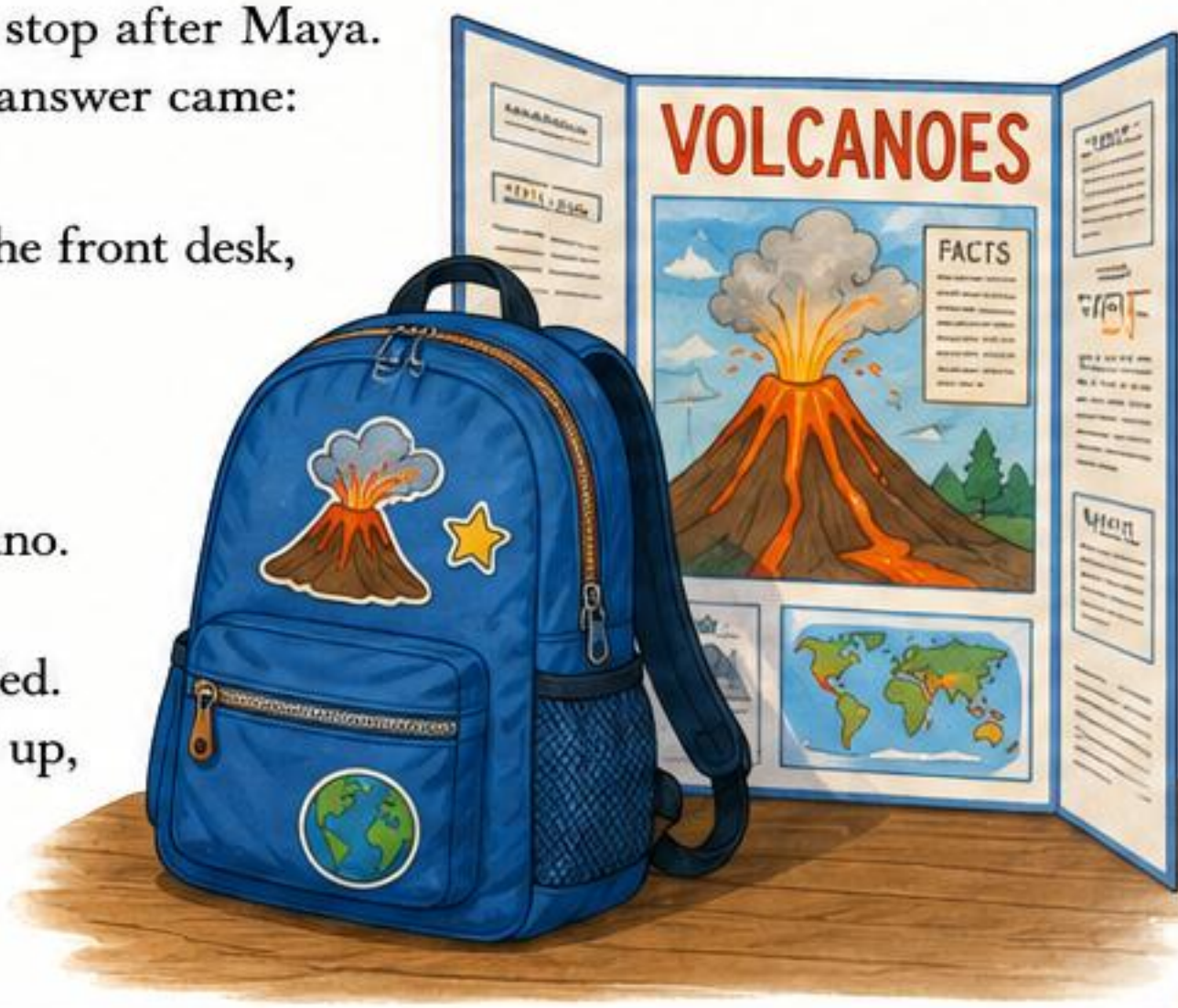
Relief washed over Maya like a warm wave. "Thank you!"

Inside, everything was just as she left it.

At the science fair, Maya stood tall as she presented her volcano. She didn't win first place, but something felt even better.

As she packed up, she looked at Leo and Mrs. Patel and smiled. "I learned that when you stay calm, ask for help, and don't give up, good things can still happen."

And sometimes, the right people show up—just in time.



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